PERKALATE FOR BRANDS

The second-visit playbook: turning first-timers into regulars

Why the second visit matters more than the first, and three ways to earn it.

The visit nobody plans for

Most marketing is built to win a first visit. Ads, launch events, opening-week deals. Then the customer walks out, and nothing happens. No reason to come back, no reminder, no next step.

That gap is expensive. A first-time customer has already found you, tried you and paid you. They're the cheapest person in the world to bring back, and most brands let them drift.

The second visit is where a habit starts. Someone who comes back once is far more likely to come back again. So if you only fix one thing in your marketing this quarter, fix this.

Why discounts on the way out don't work

The usual move is a bounce-back offer at the register: "10% off your next visit." It rarely changes much, for three reasons.

- **It goes to everyone.** Including the people who were coming back anyway.
- **It gets lost.** A paper slip or an email in a promotions tab is easy to forget.
- **It's too small to matter.** A tiny discount doesn't move anyone who wasn't already moving.

Three ways to earn visit two

1. Make the thank-you worth showing up for. One clear reward beats a stack of small ones. A free add-on service, a free class, a gift with the next purchase. Write it in one line and give it an end date.

2. Put it where they'll see it. The reward should live somewhere the customer already looks for value, not in a channel they ignore. On Perkalate, rewards sit in members' wallets right next to programs like Amex, Delta and Marriott, so they get seen.

3. Aim it at the right first-timers. Not every first-time customer needs a nudge. Focus on people who shop your category often elsewhere, since they're the ones with the most potential to become regulars.

A simple second-visit setup

Piece	Example
Audience	Verified customers in your category who live or spend near your store
Reward	A free add-on with a second purchase, valid for 30 days
Limit	One use per member
Budget	A fixed amount you set; you only pay for rewards that are used
What to watch	Viewed, claimed and redeemed, week by week

How to tell if it's working

Watch three numbers for the first two weeks. If people view the reward but don't claim it, make it more compelling. If they claim it but don't come in, make it easier to use, with a longer window or more valid times. If redemptions climb, keep it running and add a birthday reward for the regulars you're building.

The takeaway

Winning the first visit is hard. Winning the second should be easy, and it's usually where the money is. One audience, one reward, one clear limit, placed where customers already look.

Get started

Perkalate is free to start, and you only pay for the rewards you fund. 100+ brands are already on it.

Get early access at perkalate.com/brands.

Amex, Delta and Marriott are programs Perkalate members can connect. Perkalate is not affiliated with them. Examples are illustrations, not results from a specific brand.